

Meetings: Useful or a Waste of Time

Meeting Types

agenda

the list of topics for a meeting.

briefing

a short meeting that gives people important information.

one-to-one

a private meeting between two people.

team meeting

a meeting for people who work together.

video conference

a meeting held online with video.

workshop

a meeting where people work together on a task or problem.

scheduled meeting

a meeting planned for a specific time.

ad hoc meeting

a meeting arranged when a new issue comes up.

Useful Meeting Expressions

set the agenda

decide what the meeting will cover.

take minutes

write a record of what people say and decide.

give an update

explain the latest progress.

raise an issue

bring an important problem to the group's attention.

make a decision

choose what the group will do.

reach an agreement

agree on a plan or answer.

stay on track

continue to follow the agenda and time plan.

follow up on something

take the next action after a meeting.

run over

continue longer than the planned time.

wrap up

finish a meeting or discussion.

Warm-up Discussion

What kind of work do you do, and what kinds of meetings do you have?

How often do you have meetings, and how long does a typical one last?

What are your meetings usually about: updates, planning, problem-solving, or something else?

What makes a meeting feel too long?

What is one meeting that was useful? What made it useful?

What is one meeting that felt like a waste of time? What went wrong?

Discussion

What role do you usually play in a meeting? Do you lead, present, take notes, ask questions, or listen?

How can you contribute to a meeting if you do not have much to say?

Do you prefer in-person or virtual meetings? What is one advantage of your choice?

When is an ad hoc meeting helpful, and when does it create extra stress?

What meeting manners matter most, such as arriving on time, muting your microphone, or not interrupting?

How can a chairperson keep a meeting focused and stop it from running over?

When should a team send an email instead of holding a meeting?

Is it okay to eat or drink during a meeting? When might it be acceptable?

What should happen after a meeting so that decisions become real actions?

What makes a meeting necessary rather than a waste of time?